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Nixpkgs Flake Input

How should I choose the `nixpkgs` input for my flake when using `clan-core`?

Q: How should I choose the `nixpkgs` input for my flake when using `clan-core`?

A: Pin your flake to a recent `nixpkgs` version. Here are two common approaches, each with its trade-offs:

Option 1: Follow `clan-core`

- **Pros:**
 - Recommended for most users.
 - Verified by our CI and widely used by others.
- **Cons:**
 - Coupled to version bumps in `clan-core`.
 - Upstream features and packages may take longer to land.

Example:

```
1 inputs = {  
2   clan-core.url = "https://git.clan.lol/clan/clan-core/archive/25.11.tar  
3   # Use the `nixpkgs` version locked in `clan-core`  
4   nixpkgs.follows = "clan-core/nixpkgs";  
5 };
```

Option 2: Use Your Own `nixpkgs` Version

- **Pros:**
 - Faster access to new upstream features and packages.
- **Cons:**
 - Recommended for advanced users.
 - Not covered by our CI – you're on the frontier.

Example:

```
1 inputs = {
2   # Specify your own `nixpkgs` version
3   nixpkgs.url = "github:nixos/nixpkgs/nixos-unstable";
4
5   clan-core.url = "https://git.clan.lol/clan/clan-core/archive/25.11.tar.gz";
6   # Ensure `clan-core` uses your `nixpkgs` version
7   clan-core.inputs.nixpkgs.follows = "nixpkgs";
8 };
```

Recommended: Avoid Duplicate `nixpkgs` Entries

To prevent ambiguity or compatibility issues, check your `flake.lock` for duplicate `nixpkgs` entries. Duplicate entries indicate a missing `follows` directive in one of your flake inputs.

Example of duplicate entries in `flake.lock`:

```
1 "nixpkgs": {
2   "locked": {
3     "lastModified": 315532800,
4     "narHash": "sha256-1tUpklZsKzMGi3gjo/dWD+hS8cf+5Jji8TF5Cfz7i3I=",
5     "rev": "08b8f92ac6354983f5382124fef6006cade4a1c1",
6     "type": "tarball",
7     "url": "https://releases.nixos.org/nixpkgs/nixpkgs-25.11pre862603.081202.tar.gz",
8   },
9   "original": {
10    "type": "tarball",
11    "url": "https://nixos.org/channels/nixpkgs-unstable/nixexprs.tar.xz"
12  }
13 };
```

```
14 "nixpkgs_2": {
15   "locked": {
16     "lastModified": 1758346548,
17     "narHash": "sha256-afXE7AJ7MY6wY1pg/Y6UPHNPY5GtUKeBkrZZ/gC71E=",
18     "owner": "nixos",
19     "repo": "nixpkgs",
20     "rev": "b2a3852bd078e68dd2b3dfa8c00c67af1f0a7d20",
21     "type": "github"
22   },
23   "original": {
24     "owner": "nixos",
25     "ref": "nixos-25.05",
26     "repo": "nixpkgs",
27     "type": "github"
28   }
29 }
```

To locate the source of duplicate entries, grep your `flake.lock` file. For example, if `home-manager` is referencing `nixpkgs_2` instead of the main `nixpkgs`:

```
1 "home-manager": {
2   "inputs": {
3     "nixpkgs": "nixpkgs_2"
4   }
5 }
```

Fix this by adding the following line to your `flake.nix` inputs:

```
home-manager.inputs.nixpkgs.follows = "nixpkgs";
```

Repeat this process until all duplicate `nixpkgs` entries are resolved. This ensures all inputs use the same `nixpkgs` source, preventing cross-version conflicts.

How to customize pkgs?

Override an existing package

A common method to override pkgs are [overlays](#)

Rule of Thumb: Use overlays if you need to override an existing package. If you want to inject your own packages see the next point

clan.lib.clan

flake.nix

flake-parts

```

1 # flake.nix
2 {
3   inputs.clan-core.url = "https://git.clan.lol/clan/clan-core/archive/25
4   inputs.nixpkgs.follows = "clan-core/nixpkgs";
5   inputs.flake-parts.url = "github:hercules-ci/flake-parts";
6   inputs.flake-parts.inputs.nixpkgs-lib.follows = "clan-core/nixpkgs";
7
8   outputs =
9     inputs@{
10       flake-parts,
11       ...
12     }:
13     flake-parts.lib.mkFlake { inherit inputs; } {
14       systems = [
15         "x86_64-linux"
16         "aarch64-linux"
17         "x86_64-darwin"
18         "aarch64-darwin"
19       ];
20       imports = [
21         inputs.clan-core.flakeModules.default
22       ];
23
24       # https://docs.clan.lol/guides/flake-parts
25       clan = {
26         imports = [ ./clan.nix ];
27       };
28
29       perSystem =
30         { system, ... }:
31         {
32           _module.args.pkgs = import inputs.nixpkgs {
33             inherit system;
34             overlays = [
35               inputs.foo.overlays.default
36               (final: prev: {
37                 # ... things you need to patch ...

```

```
38         })
39     ];
40     config.allowUnfree = true;
41 };
42 };
43 };
44 }
```

For more examples see our [clan templates](#)

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Flake-parts

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